

film review

Derailed Ride

EK CHALIS KI LAST LOCAL

Starring: Abhay Deol, Neha Dughia
Directed by: Sanjay Khanduri

There is one superbly funny scene in *Ek Chalish...*—some goons are beating up a guy tied to a chair. The battered victim looks at the chief henchman and thinks out loud, "These two are okay but who is this third person?" The *chaiwalah*, who until then has been happily punching away, sheepishly picks up his tea tray and walks out.

Unfortunately, these



Dughia and Deol

small, whacky moments are too few and far between to shore up the story of a call centre

employee (Abhay Deol) who misses the last local train back home, unknowingly befriends a prostitute and becomes embroiled with underworld dons with guns, sadistic encounter specialist cops and sharpshooters.

Debutant director Sanjay Khanduri tries too hard to create a Quentin Tarantino-esque mix of black humour, blood, bodies and bullets. So anything is possible, including a scene in which a gay don tries to make Deol his boy toy. Deol has a wonderful unassuming charm but it isn't enough to make this derivative train ride engaging enough. **by Anupama Chopra**

music review

Musical Prayers



HMV
Rs 225

SUMIRAN
Maestro Pandit
Jasraj believes melody queen Lata

Mangeshkar is a personification

of Goddess Saraswati. Her voice encompasses not just melody but spiritualism. So listen to 23 traditional Sanskrit shlokas in the nightingale's voice, seamlessly interwoven without any breaks. The music has been composed by her brother, Pandit Hridayanath Mangeshkar, who has created music for films like *Mashaal*, *Subah* and others. His versatile style permutes and combines musical notes to surprise the listener. Attractively packed with lyrics. Must for prayerful moments.

art

Mofussil Man

KOLKATA Bhasker Mukherjee's solo exhibition, *Rooted In Realism*, is just that. Through bold brush strokes, he reiterates his concerns due to the gradual urban concretisation of villages and the degeneration of age-old values. Mukherjee, 49, an alumni of the Government College of Art and Crafts, Kolkata, moved to Birbhum (near Santiniketan) to concentrate on his passion for sketching, drawing, painting and sculpting. A founder-member of the Painters 80 group in Kolkata, he has displayed his works in India and abroad. On till June 2 at the Gallery Kanishka.

by Swagata Sen

DELHI India's first global art gallery, Bodhi Art (branches in Singapore, New York, Mumbai and now Gurgaon) is opening its large new space at the Grand Mall on



A work by Jayashree Chakravarty at Bodhi Art

Mehrauli-Gurgaon Road with an inaugural exhibition of works by 18 artists on May 25. The exhibition, comprising both paintings and sculpture, will remain open till June 30.

SHIVA'S ECSTASY

Shiva's

Mystica Music
Rs 295

When religious preachers have a good singing voice, it comes as a double boon for the listener as well

as their followers. And in the age of technological advancements, they put it to perfect use by recording songs for the spiritually inclined. In this album, Anandmurti Gurumaa presents odes to Shiva. What stands out is the musical composition and arrangement by Kanchman Babbar. He fuses western and Indian instruments in an eclectic mix to create a contemporary sound while keeping the vocals traditional. A talent to watch out for.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

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